PassFrame
TUITION

Market Day

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

The square at dawn is grey and still,
then slowly, slowly starts to fill:
a cart, a crate, a canvas sheet,
the first stall clattering down the street.

By nine o'clock the air is thick
with cries of "Apples, ripe and quick!"
and "Fresh-cut flowers, buy a few!"
and bread still warm and steaming through.

A fiddler plays a merry tune,
a juggler spins beneath the noon,
and children dart from stall to stall
with coins held tight, not spent at all.

I buy a peach, as soft as silk,
and watch a farmer pour his milk,
and think how strange it is that here,
a square so grey can hold such cheer.

By dusk the stalls are folded flat,
the fiddler gone, and that is that —
the square falls quiet, grey once more,
till market day comes round once more.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. What three objects arrive with the first stall in verse one?

2. What does the farmer do in the fourth verse?

3. Underline the line that tells you the bread was freshly baked.

4. Underline the rhyming pair of words in the final verse.

5. What does the phrase "dart from stall to stall" suggest about how the children moved?

6. Put these events in order: the square falls quiet again / stalls are set up / the poet buys a peach / the fiddler plays music.

7. Why might the poet have chosen the words "Apples, ripe and quick!" to show what the sellers shouted?

8. What time of day does the second verse describe?

9. Why do you think the poet says it is "strange" that a grey square can "hold such cheer"?

10. What does the structure of the poem (starting and ending with a quiet square) suggest about market day?

11. Find and copy a word from the poem that means "happiness" or "joy".

12. Write one or two sentences describing your own favourite part of a market or fair, using descriptive language.